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PRE-BOARD-I EXAMINATION, 2024-25

Class-X

Max. Marks-80

Subject: English

Max.Time- 3 Hours

General Instructions:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

- 1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory**
- 2. The question paper contains THREE sections – Section – A: Reading Skills**
- 3. Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills**
- 4. Section – C: Literature Textbook**
- 5. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.**

SECTION- A READING SKILLS (20 marks)

1- Read the following passage and then answer the following questions. (10)

(1) Listening is the ability to accurately receive and interpret messages in the communication process. One of the greatest gifts any of us can ever receive is the gift of listening. It is also one of the greatest gifts we can ever give. Unfortunately, it appears to be a lost art. We live in a world where everyone is talking but few are listening. What often passes for listening is simply one person pausing to collect their thoughts for their next soliloquy.

(2) Hearing refers to the sounds that you hear, whereas listening requires more than that: it requires focus. Listening means paying attention not only to the story, but how it is told, the use of language and voice, and how the other person uses his or her body. In other words, it means being aware of both verbal and non-verbal messages. Your ability to listen effectively depends on the degree to which you perceive and understand these messages.

(3) Listening is a difficult task. Like every skill, the more you do it, the better you get. Listening can be developed through practice, or lost if not used regularly. Good listeners focus on what they are hearing. They pause to think about what they've heard before responding. They ask questions because they want to know the answers, not just to keep the conversation going.

(4) So often, we are distracted with other things. We try to listen while continuing to work on the computer or watch television. To be fully present means we eliminate these distractions and focus exclusively on the other person. It takes great effort to be fully present in the moment, leaning forward, with your ears and heart open. Words are only part of the communication. Sometimes we need to experience the other person's feelings to really understand. We need to listen with our heart as well as our mind. We must repeat back what the other person has said. When we do this-and do it accurately-we communicate what we understand. It also gives us an opportunity to recalibrate our understanding if we have misunderstood something. Plenty of people are good talkers. Few are good listeners. If you develop the latter skill, you will find yourself invited into amazing conversations that wouldn't otherwise happen.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage.

i. Based on your understanding of the passage, what, according to the author, can be described as "lost art"?

Answer in about 40 words.

2

ii. Complete the sentence appropriately.

The author is disappointed that pausing to collect their thoughts is often considered as1

iii. Why does the author consider listening more than just hearing? Rationalize your response in about 40 words.

2

iv. From the sets (1)-(5) below, identify two sets of words that are opposite in meaning to each other.

1

1. Amazing – Incredible

2. Perceive- Overlook

3. Experience - Wisdom

4. Exclusively – Partially

5. Interpret - Clarify

A. 1 and 3

B. 3 and 4

C. 2 and 4

D. 1 and 5

v. Complete the sentence appropriately.

Our ability to listen effectively depends on the

1

vi. "To be fully present" in a conversation means

1

A. to constantly ask questions

B. to clear distractions and give our full attention

C. to distract the speaker

D. to change the topic of conversation

vii. To repeat back what the other person has said gives us

1

A. a chance to counter the speaker's claim

B. a way to intimidate the speaker

C. a way to distract ourselves from a topic

D. a chance to recalibrate our understanding if we have misunderstood something

viii. Which of these statements is false?

1

A. Good listeners focus on what they are hearing.

B. Listening is a skill that needs practice.

C. We don't need to experience the other person's feelings to really understand.

D. Listening is one of the greatest gifts one can ever give to someone.

2. Read the passage and then answer the following questions.

(10)

(1) Research from the Publishers Association has shown that films based on books take 44% more at the box office revenue in the UK and 53% more worldwide than original screenplays. The report explores what impact a book has when adapted for film and TV.

(2) The report reads: "Published material is the basis of 52% of top UK films in the last 10 years, and accounts for an even higher share of revenue from these leading performers, at 6% of UK box office gross and 65% of worldwide gross." The Hollywood adaptation of "My Cousin Rachel" was shown to have a significant impact on the sales of the Daphne Du Maurier thriller. The sales of the book in 2017 alone accounted for 23% of all sales since 1992.

(3) The research suggests that adapted films tend to perform better, because films can "leverage the popularity" of well-known books through an existing audience. Films adapted from books also tend to have a richer, more fully-developed story to draw on. In terms of TV adaptation, it was revealed that a quarter of dramas were based on literary sources and attracted a 56% larger share of the audience than those based on original scripts. Fourteen of the 35 high end series produced in the UK in the period between January and September 2017 were based on books, compared to seven based on true stories or historical events and five based on pre-existing films or TV stories.

(4) In the case of the 2016 BBC broadcast of "The Night Manager", research revealed that while the novel was in circulation for over 25 years, 82% of the copies it sold were in 2016 and 2017. Sales of the paperback edition remained strong in 2017 even after the series went off air.

(5) In conclusion, the report states that "there is a strong two-way relationship between publishing and the wider creative economy, wherein a successful adaptation often has spill-over effects and gives a substantial boost to the sales of the original book."

Answer the following questions, based on the passage.

i. Complete the following sentence appropriately, based on your understanding of the passage. 1

The purpose of the research by Publishers Association was to study the

ii. Select the option that is true for the two statements given below. 1

(1) The revenues generated at the box office have increased.

(2) Majority of the top films in the UK are based on published material.

A. (1) is the result of (2).

B. (1) is the reason for (2).

C. (1) is independent of (2).

D. (1) contradicts (2).

iii. Select the option that gives the correct meaning of the following statement. 1

"The sales of the book in 2017 alone accounted for 23% of all sales since 1992?"

A. There were 23% higher sales in 2017 than previous years.

B. A major chunk of sales happened in 2017.

C. The sales were limited to 23% in 2017.

D. There were very few books sold in the previous years.

iv. According to the research, the films based on books have greater success because 1

A. people like to see the characters from the books on screen

- B. the films get the advantage of the fame of the books
- C. it takes less effort for people to watch films than read books
- D. the films get a ready-made script from the books

v. Select the option listing what the given sentence refers to. 1

'Films adapted from books also tend to have a richer, more fully-developed story to draw on.'

- (1) The plot and the storyline of such films are better. (2) The characters are likely to be more vivid.
- (3) The production of such films is meant for the rich and famous.
- (4) The settings and costumes are adapted from the book.
- (5) The making of such films require the author to write a sequel.

- A. (1), (3) and (4) B. (2), (3) and (5)
- C. (1), (2) and (5) D. (1), (2) and (4)

vi. Complete the sentence appropriately. 1

The maximum TV serials in the UK in 2017, were based on

vii. Justify the following, in about 40 words. 2

Based on the research, how do the adaptations of books into films and TV dramas increase the sales of the books?

viii. "There is a two-way relationship between books and the screen". Why? Justify your answer in about 40 words. 2

SECTION-B WRITING SKILLS AND GRAMMAR (20 MARKS)

3. Complete **ANY TEN** of twelve of the following tasks, as directed. (1×10)

i. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the given sentence. (1)

Under the law of universal adult franchise, (every/few/some/many) individual has the right to vote if they are 18 years of age or older, irrespective of their cast, race, gender, religion, etc.

ii. Choose the correct option to complete the dialogue. (1)

Anita: Hey Shree. Are you free this evening?

Shree: Yes, "

Anita: Oh, that's great! Let's go shopping

- A. I am busy this evening B. I have no plans for the evening
- C. I have a date for the evening D. Sorry, I have an appointment

A. will call

B. call

C. had called

D. calls

ix Fill the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the live feed on a school news channel. (1)

Congratulations Change Makers!

The regional competition awards have been announced and our school music club _____ the first prize.

A. had been won

B. will win

C. was winning

D. has won

x. Identify the error in the given sentence and supply its correction. (1)

When he came back, he see the children playing in the garden.

INCORRECT	CORRECT

xi. Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. (1)

You have to tell your father that you want to pursuing your career in hotel business.

INCORRECT	CORRECT

xii. Report the dialogue between a teacher and a student, by completing the sentence. (1)

Teacher: Do you believe in ghosts?

Student: No. Sir there is nothing in the name of ghosts in the world.

In response to the question about his believing of ghosts, the student refuses and says that

4. Attempt **ANY ONE** of the two questions, given below. 5

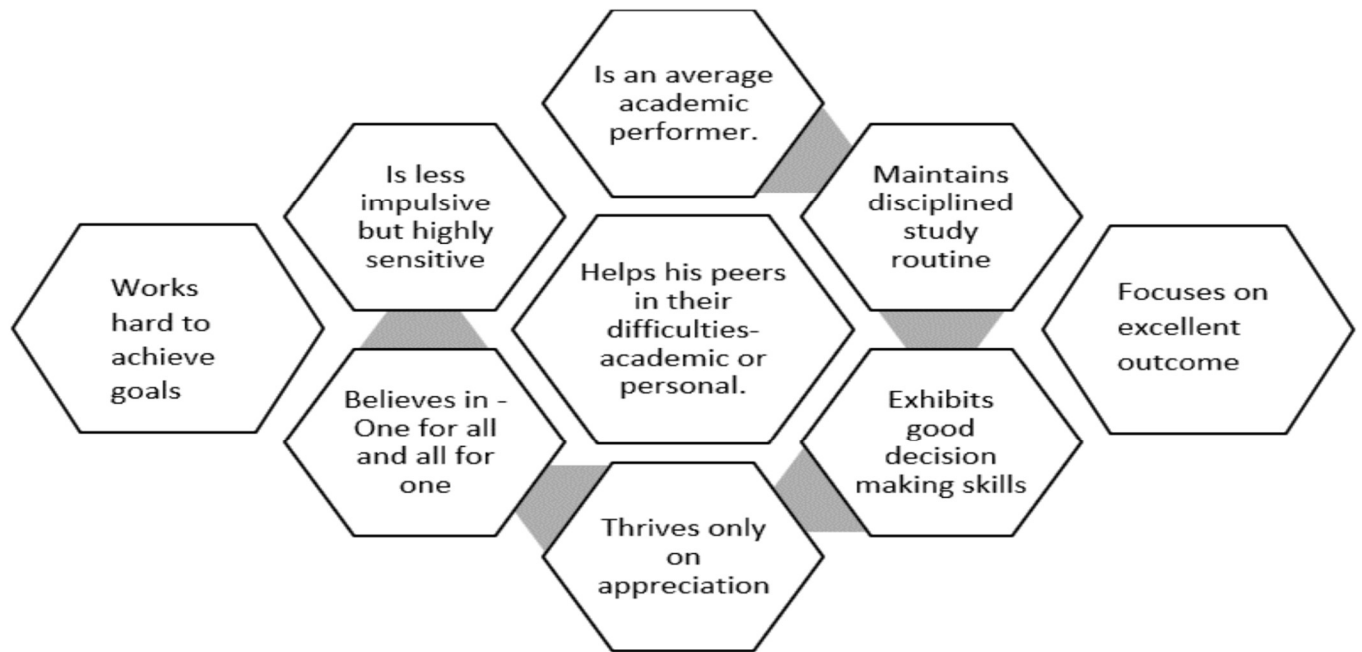
A. This summer vacation you are planning to visit Shimla. Write a letter to a travel agency in Shimla, in about 120 words, requesting them to book you a room in a five-star hotel. Give other details of your journey and the facilities you require there. Sign your name as Sonam, C/5, West 1 Bengal.

OR

4. B. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the Editor of a newspaper about the insanitary conditions prevailing in your locality and the indifference of the Municipal authorities in spite of repeated letters of complaint. You are Dimpy from Jagran Colony, Nagpur.

5. Attempt **ANY ONE** of the two questions, given below. 5

Anchal, of class X, is contesting for the post of the Junior School Captain, in the upcoming student council elections. Given below is her character traits' graphic, shared in the public domain, by the school counsellor, for the awareness of student voters, at school.



All Anchal's peers have been asked to write a paragraph in about 120 words, analysing these traits, to either support or oppose her candidature. As one of her peers, write this analytical paragraph, by selecting some of the traits that support your analysis.

You may begin like this:

As a responsible student voter, I believe Anchal possesses / does not possess the necessary traits to be a School Captain.

You may end like this:

For these reasons, I believe she has / does not have the potential to be a good School Captain and I support / oppose her candidature.

OR

The graph given shows estimated sales of gold in Dubai in 2002. Write an analytical paragraph describing the line graph in around 150 words.



6. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for **ANY ONE** of the two, given. 5

A. Enlightened after seven days, he renamed the tree the Bodhi Tree (Tree of Wisdom) and began to teach and to share his new understandings. At that point, he became known as the Buddha (The Awakened or the Enlightened).

i. What enlightenment came over him? 1

- A. He was enlightened about family and his loved ones.
- B. He was enlightened about his purpose in life.
- C. He was enlightened about the true meaning of pain and suffering.
- D. He was enlightened about his kingdom.

ii. Where did Buddha sit down for meditation, and what did he do after being enlightened? 2

Elaborate your answer in about 40 words.

iii. After attaining enlightenment, other than Buddha, he was known as 1

iv. Which statement is false from the following? 1

- A. Buddha is also known as the Awakened.
- B. Buddha renamed the Tree of Wisdom.
- C. Buddha took 7 years to be enlightened.
- D. Buddha took 7 days to be enlightened.

OR

B. "I returned another to you exactly like it. And it has taken us ten years to pay for it. You can understand that it was not easy for us who have nothing. But it is finished and I am decently content." Mme Forestier stopped short. She said, "You say that you bought a diamond necklace to replace mine?" "Yes. You did not perceive it then? They were just alike."

i. 'You' in the first line is 1

- A. Mme Loisel
- B. Mme Forestier
- C. M Loisel
- D. Mme Ramponneau

ii. 'It' in the first line of the extract is referring to 1

iii. Meaning of word 'content' is 1

- A. things
- B. satisfied
- C. worried
- D. regretted

iv. What took Loises ten years, and why? Elaborate your answer in about 40 words. 2

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for **ANY ONE** of the two, given.

5

A. Don't eat that chocolate, Amanda!
Remember your acne, Amanda!
Will you please look at me
When I am speaking to you, Amanda!
(I am Rapunzel, I have not care;
life in a tower is tranquil and rare;)

i. Who reminded Amanda of her acne and why? Answer in about 40 words.

2

ii. "Will you please look at me" here means

1

A. stop ignoring me

B. keep looking at me

C. please don't be angry at me

D. please speak to me

iii. Amanda is Rapunzel because she feels

.....

1

iv. Which statement is false?

1

A. Amanda's mother is nagging.

B. Amanda loves chocolate.

C. Amanda likes being nagged around by her mother.

D. Amanda uses imagination as a means of escape.

OR

B. Some say the world will end in fire

Some say in ice.

From what I've tasted of desire

I hold with those who favour fire.

i. What is the poet's opinion of the world in these lines? Answer in about 40 words.

2

ii. "tasted of desire" the poet is

1

A. missing desire
something

B. talking about his experience of desiring

C. afraid of tasting desire

D. never known desire

iii. Find out the rhyming words in the given extract.

1

iv. Choose the correct synonym of 'Desire'.

1

A. Assure

B. Wish

C. Plead

D. Entrap

8. Answer **ANY FOUR** of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words.

(4x3=12)

- i. Do you think that Lencho was right to call the post office employees a bunch of crooks? Why I or why not?
- ii. From whom have the inhabitants of Coorg descended, as per the legend?
- iii. What is the theme of the poem-"The Ball Poem"?
- iv. What did the military generals do? How did their attitude change and why?
- v. Why did the young seagull remain all alone on the ledge?

9. Answer **ANY TWO** of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words.

(2x3=6)

- i. What was Tricki's condition when Mrs. Pumphrey recollected him?
- ii. What guesses are made by Think-Tank about the books found on Earth?
- iii. 'Anil walked away. I followed casually'. Why do you think the narrator followed Anil?

10. Answer **ANY ONE** of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words.

(6)

A. 'The Proposal' is a great comedy and full of great humour. Explain the sentence.

OR

B. Give a brief character sketch of Valli.

11. Answer **ANY ONE** of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words.

(6)

A. Write a paragraph on the role of education in about 120 words with reference to the chapters The Making of a Scientist and Bholi. You may begin this way: Education plays a very crucial role in the overall development of a person.

OR

B. Horace was clever but the lady in the red was cleverer. Do you agree with this statement? Justify your answer.